Disorders of purine or pyrimidine metabolism	Lesch–Nyhan syndrome
Transport disorders	Cystinuria Hypercholesterolemia
Peroxisomal disorders	Adrenoleukodystrophy
Urea cycle disorders	Citrullinemia, Ornithine transcarbomylase deficiency
Metal metabolic disorders	Wilson's disease

7.1 GALACTOSEMIA

Galactosemia, first described in 1908 by Von Reuss, is a genetic disease, characterized by the inability to process galactose, which is found in many foods. galactosemia implies 'galactose in the blood'. Galactose, a sugar byproduct of lactose, is present in cow's milk, breast milk and dairy products. As a result, if not treated , it builds up in the tissues and blood causing life threatening problems. The incidence of this disease is about 1 in 18,000 livebirths.

7.1.1 Causes

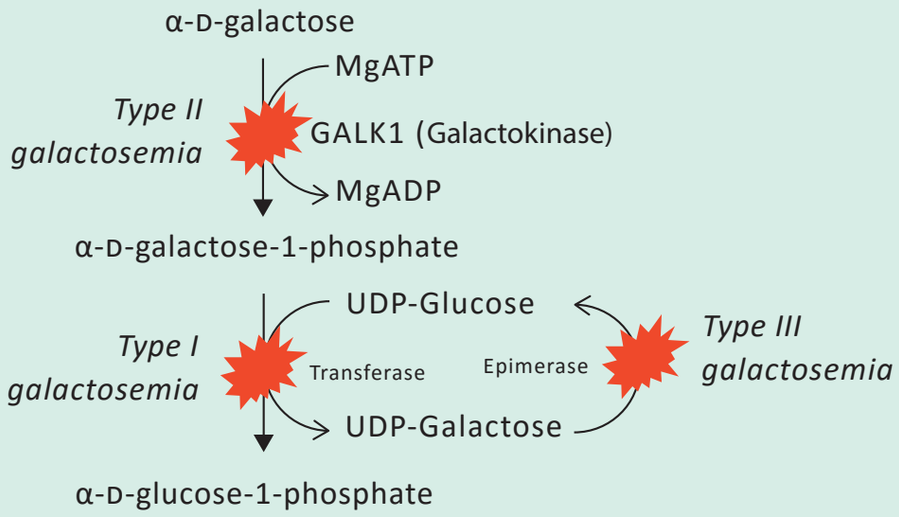


Figure 7.1 Pathways of Galactose metabolism

Galactosemia occurs when a specific enzyme known as galactose-1-phosphate uridyltransferase (GALT) is absent. This enzyme present in liver is responsible for breaking down galactose into glucose. In normal subjects, GALT binds to galactose, and converts it into glucose. However, in galasctosemia, due to the absence of GALT, galactose-1-

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